

Some smartphones arrive with fireworks. The Samsung Galaxy S26 Ultra takes a quieter route. On paper, it looks familiar. The same 6.9-inch QHD+ display, a 5,000mAh battery and four cameras on the back. At first glance, it feels like a small refresh.

But spend time with it and the story changes. The S26 Ultra is built on changes one had asked for. Each improvement feels subtle on its own, yet together they make the phone quicker, smarter and more intuitive. It is less about flashy upgrades and more about a device that quietly gets better at everything it already did well.

Sculpted Power

Samsung has refined rather than reinvented the Ultra design. The phone remains large, premium and unmistakably flagship. The frame feels solid, the finish is polished and the build quality inspires confidence.

There is comfort in this familiarity. The Galaxy Ultra design has matured into something instantly recognisable. A device that feels serious the moment it lands in your hand.

Private Brilliance

The 6.9-inch QHD+ display remains one of the finest panels on any smartphone. It is bright, sharp and immersive enough to make videos and games look spectacular.

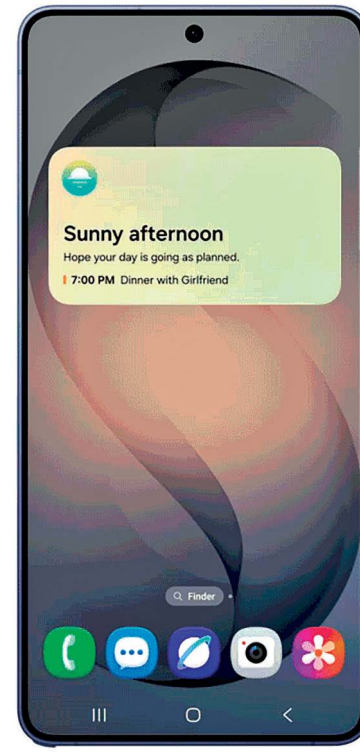
The headline feature this year is the built-in privacy display. Activate it and the viewing angle narrows so only the person holding the phone can see the screen clearly. Anyone beside you sees little more than a dim blur. In crowded public spaces that turns out to be genuinely useful.

AI Engine

Under the hood sits the Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 for Galaxy, delivering noticeable gains in CPU, GPU and AI performance. Yet the bigger shift is how the phone uses that power.

Samsung's Galaxy AI now moves toward what it calls Agentic AI. The phone anticipates tasks instead of waiting for commands. If someone asks for photos, the device can surface them instantly. A meeting message can trigger a quick calendar check for conflicts.

Much of this processing happens directly on the device and is protected through Knox Enhanced Encrypted Protection, reducing dependence on cloud servers.



THE VERDICT

The Galaxy S26 Ultra does not reinvent the flagship smart wheel. Instead, it adds extra grip to it. With powerful hardware, thoughtful AI and excellent cameras, it delivers a refined experience where small improvements add up to something really meaningful.
Price: ₹ 1,89,999 (1TB)

Light Master

The 200MP main camera now features a brighter f/1.4 aperture, allowing more light to reach the sensor. Low-light shots appear cleaner and more detailed.

Behind the scenes, an upgraded AI image processor and Samsung's colour engine refine tones and textures. Photos feel more natural rather than aggressively processed.